

on the limestone temple, it is precise and rich. The length of the building, 87 ft (26.5 m), is almost exactly twice its width, 44 ft (13.5 m).

Pyramid of Cestius

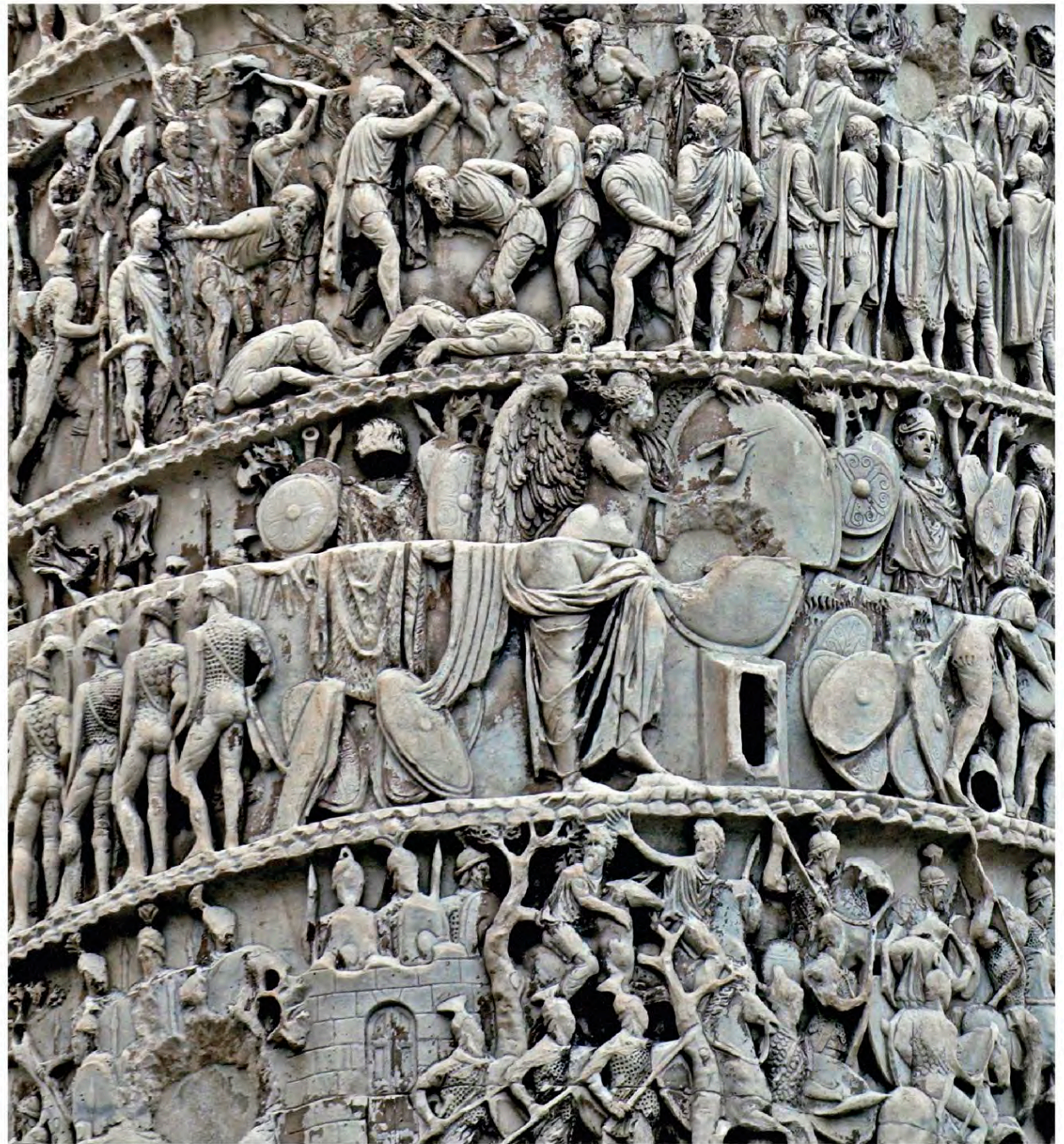
Location Rome, Italy

The Pyramid of Cestius—in effect an imperial Roman–Egyptian pyramid—is among Rome’s most surprising structures. It was built in about 15 BCE, as the tomb of senator Gaius Cestius. Its form is explained by a sudden taste for Egyptian art after the Roman conquest of Egypt in 31 BCE; its unusual steepness suggests that it was modeled on similar Nubian pyramids. The base of each side is 95 ft (29 m) long, and it rises 121 ft (37 m). It is built of concrete and brick, which is faced with marble. Contemporary Latin inscriptions on two walls explain whose tomb it is and who built it. In the late 3rd century CE, the pyramid was incorporated into new city walls, of which it still forms a part.

Temple of Mars Ultor

Location Rome, Italy

Other than a few steps, three battered columns, and the stubs of four more columns, little remains of the Temple of Mars Ultor—“Mars the Avenger.” It was completed in 2 BCE on the orders of the Emperor Augustus to commemorate his victory at the Battle of Philippi in 42 BCE over the assassins of his great-uncle Julius Caesar. Raised on a platform reached by steps, the temple’s portico had rows of 59-ft- (18-m-) high Corinthian columns on three sides, above which sat a massive carved pediment. The temple dominated the huge Forum of Augustus. Together, they had been one of the most imposing sights of imperial Rome, reinforcing Augustus’s claim, “I found Rome a city of bricks and left it a city of marble.”



Trajan's Bridge

Location Alcántara, Spain

Trajan's Bridge, named after the Spanish-born Emperor Trajan who ordered its construction, was completed in 105 CE. With a total length of 623 ft (190 m), the bridge spans the Tagus River on what is now the Spanish–Portuguese border. Much like Pont du Gard (see pp.100–101), it exemplifies the Roman genius for engineering, which also produced impressive architecture. It has six huge stone-built arches—the most

characteristic of Roman engineering solutions. The vast masonry of the two central arches rises 157 ft (48 m) above the river. Straddling the bridge's center is the structure's only nonfunctional element—a severe, castellated triumphal arch.

Trajan's Column

Location Rome, Italy

The Roman practice of creating imposing public monuments to celebrate military triumphs was given new form in Trajan's Column, built

▲ BAS-RELIEF ON TRAJAN'S COLUMN CELEBRATING ROMAN VICTORY IN DACIA

in 112 CE. Made of a series of huge marble drums, the column is 115 ft (35 m) high and originally featured an immense, gilded statue of Trajan at its summit. It celebrates the victories of Trajan in Dacia, in the region of modern-day Romania, in two campaigns between 101 and 106 CE. It is decorated with a continuous spiral of carving, in relief, climbing up and around the column, forming a dense narrative of Trajan's conquests. It features around 2,500 individual figures, and, if unraveled, it would be more than 600 ft (183 m) long.